Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of the seven colours orange stands between red and yellow. On the rainbow map of the chakras it is the second and belongs to the sacral chakra. You can imagine it as a place for **experiencing**, **pleasure** and the feeling of **“what delights me”**.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

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Svadhisthana, the sacral chakra

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The sacral chakra is called Svadhisthana (in Sanskrit “one's own abode”). It dwells in the area of the lower abdomen. The element of water, the sound syllable **VAM** and a lotus with six petals belong to it. In the classical descriptions the petals are vermilion red.

Its theme is **pleasure**, the senses, **relationships**, creativity and **emotions**. For women this is often translated into questions. Do I allow myself to enjoy things? Can I create without fear of being judged? Can I feel without being ashamed of it? Our sense of guilt can often hold it back.

When the chakra is open. You are allowed to enjoy everything fully. Food, touch, beauty, creating. Your emotions flow. You enjoy relationships and closeness.

When the chakra is closed. You may feel numbness, shame, fear, guilt about pleasure, or on the contrary embarrassment. Or you may chase after joy in vain. **A closed chakra does not mean a bad one.** It is only a signal that perhaps you do not yet allow yourself to enjoy life. That you do not see the possibilities.

How to add orange when you are missing pleasure

- **Wear it**
  An orange scarf, jumper, socks or a piece of jewellery. Something you can keep close to the body.
- **Put it in your home**
  An orange cushion, mug or blanket. Oranges on the table.
- **Eat it**
  Citrus fruit, carrots, pumpkin, apricots. Slowly and with relish.
- **Get creating**
  Orange paint and a brush, with no goal.
- **Fit it into an ordinary day**
  A sunset, a lit candle, orange light.
- **Treat yourself to joy**
  An orange pencil, notebook or a mug that makes you laugh. A small thing just for joy.

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When and how to top up orange when you are missing pleasure in life

When you are running on nothing but experiences and the body already wants rest, you do not need more orange, but something that slows you down.

- **Add blue**
  Its opposite and calm. A blue lamp, blue bedding, water.
- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, leather, natural fabrics.
- **Mute the orange**
  Replace a rich one with peach or terracotta.
- **Add cream**
  A soft and calm base. Linen, cotton, light bedding.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

For some time now you have simply been “functioning”. You get up, work, take care of what needs doing, and in the evening you tick off another day. Nothing essential has to be falling apart. It is just that something you look forward to has gradually faded out of it.

This is exactly where orange can get its personal meaning, **life is not just something you have to manage**. You can also feel it, taste it and enjoy it.

Next to orange other colours can feel warmer or calmer. Blue cools it, brown grounds it and cream softens it. **These are possibilities of personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add orange because you are missing joy and the wish to try things? Or do you take it away because everything is already overflowing? **You choose the meaning.** Both options can be fine. For the second chakra, for example, the classical descriptions tend to mention vermilion red rather than orange.

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